

ways to maximise reuse, recycling, and recovery. Transitioning from a linear economy to a circular one, HUL aims to retain the value of materials for as long as possible. This strategy aligns with the company's purpose of making sustainable living commonplace, recognising the intersection of sustainable business practices and financial success," Biddappa adds.

Salts-to-cigarettes major ITC Ltd has a wide-ranging sustainability programme spanning its verticals that cover Kolkata and the hinterlands of Bengal alike. As per the company spokesperson, for more than 25 years, ITC has been religiously pushing a benchmark in sustainability, guided by its 'Responsible Competitiveness' philosophy.

ITC's climate strategy is two-fold, focusing on transitioning to a low-carbon economy while adapting to climate change impacts. The company sources 50% of its energy needs from renewable sources and is implementing projects like the high-pressure recovery boiler at the Bhadrachalam paper mill to reduce its coal consumption by 25%.

Global data shows FMCG majors, including the ones operating in India, are a major source of Scope 3 GHG emissions. According to London-based analytics and consulting firm GlobalData, Swiss FMCG giant Nestlé SA added more CO₂ equivalent in 2021 than any of its peers.

"Nestlé SA is a leading Scope 3 greenhouse gas emitter. In 2021, Nestlé's Scope 3 emissions were 113,700 thousand tonnes of CO₂ equivalents, accounting for around 95.8% of total GHG emissions," it said in a report. It is followed by the Brazil-based meat processing major JBS SA and Unilever (Anglo-Dutch parent entity of HUL) with 65,000 and 61,000 tonnes of CO₂ equivalent,



“Sustainability is about balancing consumer needs with environmental stewardship. Dabur is not only creating eco-friendly products but also greening its entire operations and value chain”

MOHIT MALHOTRA
CEO, DABUR INDIA

lents, respectively, in the same year. Henkel, Colgate-Palmolive, ABIn-Bev, Mondelez International, Danone, and General Mills were the other large emitters globally.

"Greenhouse gas emissions are one of the major causes of rising global warming, and companies from the FMCG sector account for a significant amount of global emissions. CO₂, Methane & NOx gases form a major part of greenhouse gases released from Fossil Fuels such as gas and oil," analysts at GlobalData noted. FMCG companies are under increasing pressure to reduce their carbon footprint. Consumers are becoming more aware of the impact of excess carbon dioxide emissions on the environment. According to

GlobalData, consumption behaviour has changed due to awareness.

In response to BT's detailed questionnaire Nestlé India's spokesperson says, its "sustainability commitment focuses on climate change, packaging, responsible sourcing, and water. We have been a pioneer in responsibly managing an amount equivalent to the post-consumer plastic waste generated by its products. Since 2020, our brands have remained plastic neutral."

Mumbai-based FMCG major Marico's commitment to environmental stewardship has meant it consistently prioritises sustainable practices in all facets of operations. "From the moment we set our foundation, we recognised the vital role environmental consciousness plays in our decision-making process, thereby embedding it as a core value," says Amit Bhasin, Chief Legal Officer & Group General Counsel and Secretary of CSR Committee at Marico Ltd.

Marico aims to pivot to a circular economy by ensuring 100% recyclable packaging by 2027 and integrating 30% recycled post-consumer resin into its product packaging, while Dabur became the first Indian consumer goods company to be Plastic Waste Positive by recycling 35,000 MT of plastic waste.

While FMCG companies have made notable progress in addressing their environmental impact, significant challenges remain in the journey toward true sustainability. Efforts to reduce emissions are often hindered by complex global supply chains, limited access to low-carbon alternatives, and inconsistent regulations across regions. Companies would also have to invest in scalable, systemic solutions that integrate sustainability into core business strategies, to reduce their carbon footprint. **BT**